

Persuasive technologies and behavioral change

- Interactive computing systems deliberately designed to change people's attitudes and behaviors (Fogg, 2003)
- A diversity of techniques now used to change what users do or think
 - Pop-up ads, warning messages, reminders, prompts, personalized messages, recommendations, Amazon 1-click
 - Commonly referred to as nudging

Nintendo's Pocket Pikachu

- Changing bad habits and improving well being
 - Designed to motivate children to be more physically active on a regular basis
 - owner of the digital pet that 'lives' in the device is required to walk, run, or jump
 - If owner does not exercise the virtual pet becomes angry and refuses to play anymore

How effective?

- Is the use of novel forms of interactive technologies (e.g., the combination of sensors and dynamically updated information) that monitor, nag, or send personalized messages intermittently to a person more effective at changing a person's behavior than non-interactive methods, such as the placement of warning signs, labels, or ads in prominent positions?

Which is most effective?



Figure 5.11 Stairs versus elevators: static sign versus ambient persuasive displays. Which is most persuasive?